

WESTERN SWING

LEAD GUITAR STYLES



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Here are the hot licks and phrases that make up the Western Swing lead style.

At least until the late 1940s, the history of Western Swing guitar and jazz guitar are the same. In the late 1940s, jazz music moved into the Bebop era and on into the "cool" jazz of the 1950s and 60s. Western Swing guitar is a snapshot of jazz guitar in the 1930s and 40s when the music was young and exciting.

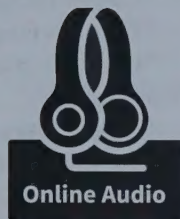


WESTERN

SWING

LEAD GUITAR STYLES

by Joe Carr



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Audio Contents

Track #	Page #	Track #	Page #
1. Shape to Shape 1	7	21. Diminished Progression 2	21
2. Shape to Shape 2	7	22. Dim Riff Blues*	22
3. Shape to Shape 3	7	23. Augmented Substitution	23
4. Progression in Shapes 1	7	24. Aug Dim Riff Blues*	23
5. Progression in Shapes 2	8	25. Clark's Blues*	24
6. Progression in Shapes 3	8	26. Sleepy Blues*	26
7. Progression in Shapes 4	8	27. Eldon's Rag*	28
8. Lead Notes in The Shapes	8	28. Jimmy's Blues*	30
9. Shape Blues*	9	29. Jimmy's Blues #2*	32
10. Riff Blues #1*	10	30. "G" Shape	34
11. Riff Blues #2*	11	31. Jimmy's Rag—solos 1 & 2*	34
12. Riff Blues #3*	12	32. Junior's Tune*	36
13. Riff Blues #4*	13	33. Cotton Picking—solos 1 & 2*	38
14. "F" Major Scale and Arpeggio	18	34. Harold's Rag*	40
15. "Bb" Major Scale and Arpeggio	18	35. Charlie's Blues*	42
16. "D" Major Scale and Arpeggio	18	36. Guitar Blues for Two*	44
17. Arp Blues*	19	37. Two Guitar Boogie*	46
18. Minor Sub Riff Blues*	20	38. Harmony Rag*	48
19. Diminished Substitution	21	39. Tuning	
20. Diminished Progression 1	21		

* practice rhythm track follows guitar solo.

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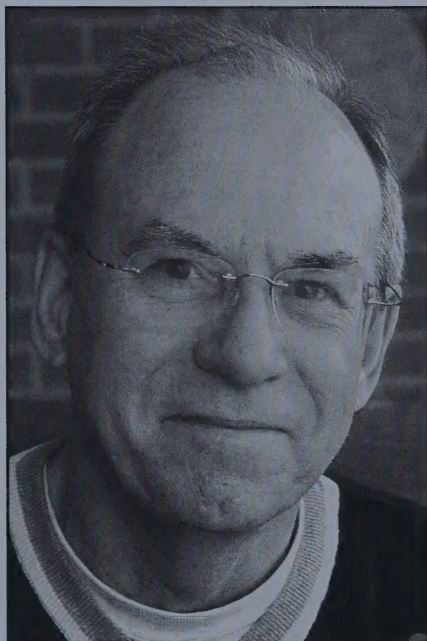
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Table of Contents

About the Author	2	Diminished Substitution - "Dim Riff Blues"	22
Introduction	3	Augmented Substitution -	
About this Book	3	"Aug Dim Riff Blues"	23
Music Theory Crash Course	4	Thoughts about Learning to Use Substitutions	24
Scales and Chords	4	All Together Now - "Clark's Blues"	24
Chord Formula	5	More Solos	26
Chord Progressions and the Number System	5	"Sleepy Blues"	26
Lead Guitar - Pathways on the Neck	6	"Eldon's Rag"	28
Three Shapes	6	"Jimmy's Blues"	30
Shape to Shape	7	"Jimmy's Blues #2"	32
Progressions in Shapes	7	"Jimmy's Rag"	34
Lead Notes in Shapes	8	"Junior's Tune"	36
"Shape Blues"	9	"Cotton Picking"	38
12 Bar Riff Blues	10	"Harold's Rag"	40
"Riff Blues" #1-#4	10	"Charlie's Blues"	41
"Riff Blues" #1-#4 - 7th Position	14	Twin Guitar	43
The Major Scale and Arpeggio	18	"Guitar Blues for Two"	43
Substitutions	19	"Two Guitar Boogie"	45
Direct Substitution - "Arp Blues"	19	"Harmony Rag"	47
Minor Substitution - "Minor Sub Riff Blues" ..	20		



About the Author

Joe Carr appears in over twenty instructional guitar videos ranging from country to swing, bluegrass and even heavy metal! Add to these his videos on mandolin, fiddle, banjo and ukulele and Joe may be the most recorded video instructor anywhere. He has produced numerous book/CD combinations for Mel Bay Publications including "First Lessons in Flatpicking Guitar" and "Western Swing Guitar Styles" which explains Western Swing rhythm chords.

Joe is a self-taught musician who started guitar at age 13. After six years touring with Alan Munde in the internationally acclaimed bluegrass group COUNTRY GAZETTE, Joe left to join the music faculty in the unique commercial music program at South Plains College in Levelland, Texas.

Today, in addition to teaching, Joe continues to perform in a duo setting with former employer and South Plains College colleague, Alan Munde. Alan and Joe have recorded three CD's under their names completed an award-winning book on west Texas country music in 1995.

Introduction

Western Swing music, that infectious blend of old time fiddle, hot solos and a swinging beat, did not feature lead guitar prominently in its infancy. Early 1930s recordings of the Light Crust Doughboys and Milton Brown's Musical Brownies primarily featured fiddle and later the steel guitar on hot "takeoff" solos. The guitar, usually acoustic, was generally a rhythm instrument, although the louder tenor banjo was often used in this role.

Largely due to the increasing availability of the new electric guitar in the mid 1930s, the guitar began to have a larger role as a lead instrument in the music world. Sophisticated guitarists such as the Texas Playboy's Eldon Shamblin brought a jazzy lead guitar approach to his developing music. The guitar soon joined the fiddle, steel guitar, piano and horns as equal partners in the band. The relatively simple chord structure of the Western Swing repertoire gave these soloists a wonderful palate on which to create their improvised musical pictures.

It should be remembered that Western Swing music was developed by young people. These young musicians listened to and were influenced by the hot swing and jazz dance music of the day. Just as later generations of musicians have copied the pop music of the day, these musicians studied the recordings of Benny Goodman and other popular contemporary dance orchestras.

When jazz guitar pioneer Charlie Christian introduced his ground-breaking solo style with Goodman's organization, Western Swing guitarists were listening and quickly incorporated Christian's ideas into their own playing.

Therefore, students of Western Swing lead guitar should spend a lot of time listening to jazz and swing recordings of the 1930s and 40s. Here are the hot licks and phrases that make up the western swing lead style. The jazzy sounds of swing music are heard less often in today's music. Tones such as the 13th, 9th, 11th or even more "normal" tones such as the 6th and 9th, may sound "odd" to modern ears which are accustomed to rather bland contemporary pop music.

At least until the late 1940s, the history of Western Swing guitar and jazz guitar are the same. In the late 1940s, jazz music moved into the Bebop era and on into the "cool jazz" of the 1950s and 60s. It is interesting to note that while jazz has moved away from its "dance beat" origins, Western Swing fans have kept dancing. In many ways, Western Swing guitar is a snapshot of jazz guitar in the 1930s and 40s when the music was young and exciting.

About this Book

While much Western Swing soloing is improvised, a careful study of the ideas presented here will give aspiring guitarists a swing vocabulary from which to draw. The chord progressions used here are not specific songs, but are similar to many of the most popular western swing standards. Just as in jazz, Western Swing soloists seldom state the unadorned melody during their rides (or solos). Bob Wills reportedly told his musicians, "When I point to you, I want you to play everything you know."

After a discussion of chord formula and progressions, we will learn three shapes which can be used to organize your understanding of the fingerboard. Careful visualization of shapes is an important skill which should be used throughout this book. The shape system can be used to organize all your future learning.

In the second section, a 12 bar riff blues is used to introduce increasingly complex musical ideas. The section on substitution introduces several ways to dress up basic solos. The final section is comprised of solos for several popular Western Swing chord progressions in the styles of noted guitarists.

The theory points: While this is not a music theory book, these solos are often sophisticated and may need some theory to explain what is going on throughout the solos. Numbers in parenthesis (*) are used to identify interesting chord tones. These numbers relate to the current chord in the arrangement, not the key of the song. Numbers below notes indicate which left-hand finger is used.

Please borrow or steal these licks and phrases and try them in your playing. Careful study of these swing style solos will help your own original solos sound more authentic. Once you take an idea from this book and use it in a new situation, you will truly "own" it.

Music Theory Crash Course

You needn't memorize this material before moving on. As you work through the solos in this book, refer to this section for answers to questions that may arise.

Scales and Chords

Major Scales - The "Do-Re-Mi" scale consists of seven notes which can be numbered 1 through 7. The C scale looks like this:

C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	1

The major scale is made up of a specific order of whole step and half step intervals, which is:

whole step, whole step, half step, whole step, whole step, whole step, half step.

This is true in all keys. Each key has its own note names, but the sequence of intervals is the same for every key. On the guitar, a half step is one fret.

Major Chords

Major chords are made from the 1st, 3rd & 5th notes of the major scale. In the key of C, this is C, E & G. These notes played together, in any order or combination, form a C major chord.

Minor Chords (Sometimes indicated with a minus sign or lower case "m")

Minor chords are made from the 1st, flatted 3rd & 5th intervals of the major scale. This means that the 3rd is lowered one half step (one fret.) In the key of C, this is C, E $\flat$ & G.

Dominant Chords

This large chord family includes the popular 7th chord which uses the 1st, 3rd, 5th and flatted 7th notes of the major scale. The C7 chord is spelled C, E, G & B $\flat$.

Altered Chords

For our purposes, we'll put some special-use chords in this group.

Diminished - Essentially a 7th chord with everything but the root flatted one half step. It uses the 1, flatted 3rd, flatted 5th and double flatted 7th. In C: C, E $\flat$, G $\flat$ and B $\flat\flat$.

Augmented and Augmented 7th - Often indicated with a (+) sign, augmented means "sharp five." A straight augmented chord is 1, 3, $\sharp 5$ while an augmented 7th is 1, 3, $\sharp 5$, $\flat 7$. These two chords are often interchangeable.

Suspended - This chord, often written (sus), is popular in modern music, but less often seen in swing. Suspended generally refers to a chord that spells: 1, 4, 5 - with no third. The resulting chord generally "wants" to resolve to a major (1, 3, 5) chord. The dominant 11th chord also uses the 4th tone, but is used differently. A suspended 2 chord has no third. It spells 1, 2, 5 and also generally "wants" to resolve to a major (1, 3, 5) chord. See the chord formula list that follows.

Chord Formula

Each chord type has a formula. Some chords, use numbers above seven. Here is a two-octave C scale:

C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15

Notice that the D note is both 2 and 9. Likewise, the F note is 4 and 11 and the A note is 6 and 13. This is important to understand how chords are named.

<u>MAJOR TYPE</u>	<u>MINOR TYPE</u>	<u>DOMINANT TYPE</u>	<u>ALTERED TYPE</u>
Major - 1,3,5,	Minor - 1, $\flat$ 3,5	7th - 1,3,5, $\flat$ 7	Diminished - 1, $\flat$ 3, $\flat$ 5, $\flat\flat$ 7
Sixth - 1,3,5,6	Minor 6th - 1, $\flat$ 3,5,6	9th - 1,3,5, $\flat$ 7,9	Augmented - 1,3, $\sharp$ 5
Major 7th - 1,3,5,7	Minor 7th - 1, $\flat$ 3,5, $\flat$ 7	11th - 1,3,5, $\flat$ 7,9,11	Augmented 7th - 1,3, $\sharp$ 5, $\flat$ 7
Major 9th - 1,3,5,7,9	Minor 9th - 1, $\flat$ 3,5, $\flat$ 7,9	13th - 1,3,5, $\flat$ 7,9,11,13	Suspended - 1,4,5

Chord Progressions and the Number System

We can use the major scale to identify any chord by number. For example, if we are in the key of C, we can call C the one (I) chord. An F chord would be called the four (IV) chord and G, the (V). If this is confusing, review the information under "major scales." Below is a chord chart for a 12-measure song in the key of C. Each letter represents four beats.

C-C-C-C / F-F-C-C / G-F-C-C

If we convert chords to numbers, we would have:

I-I-I-I / IV-IV-I-I / V-IV-I-I

*Note: In this book, Roman numerals indicate chords, Arabic numerals indicate chord tones.

The advantage to this system is that if we move to a new key, the chords will change names, but the number chart will stay the same.

Example: Key of D

D	D	D	D	G	G	D	D	A	G	D	D
I	I	I	I	IV	IV	I	I	V	IV	I	I

This approach allows us to see similarities in different songs. This is important improvising skill.

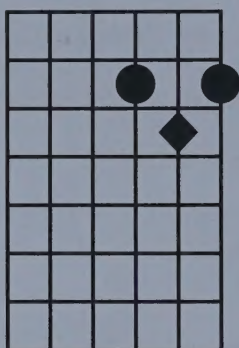
Lead Guitar—Pathways on the Neck

There are many ways to think about lead guitar - scales, modes arpeggios and shapes are just a few. Most guitarists combine several of these concepts in their soloing. This section discusses shapes as a way to organize soloing ideas.

In western swing lead, as in other styles, one popular soloing approach consists of stringing together a series of “licks” or “riffs” which fit a given chord situation. Some guitarists use this technique sparingly, while for others, it is the basis of their style. Many guitarists “see” these licks or phrases as belonging to a specific chord shape. The advantage to this system is that the lick can easily be moved to any key.

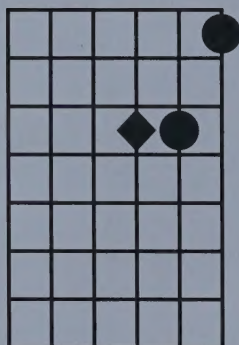
Three Shapes

Guitarists often use two and three shapes to help organize musical ideas. Let’s look at three of the most common shapes - “D”, “B $\flat$ ” and “F”. The true name of the chord depends on where they are placed on the neck.

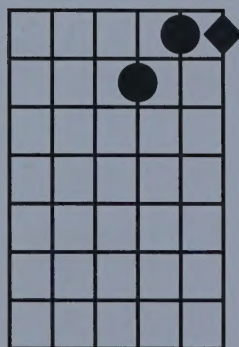


◆ = Root note (The root note is the note that names the chord.)

Shape 1 - The “D” shape played at the second fret. This chord spells 5-1-3 (from low to high) so the “name” of the chord is on the second string. Memorize the new name at each fret between 1 and 12.



Shape 2 - The “B $\flat$ ” shape played at the first fret. This chord spells 1-3-5, so the name of the chord is on the third string. Memorize these chords from frets 1-12.

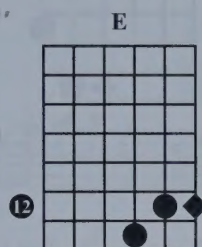
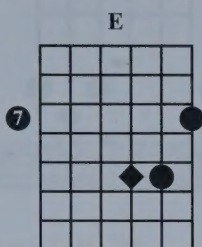
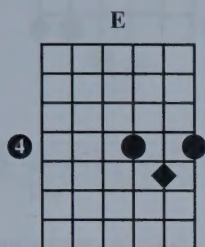


Shape 3 - The “F” shape played at the first fret. This chord spells 3-5-1 so the name of the chord is on the first string. Memorize the new name at each fret from 1-12.

Shape to Shape

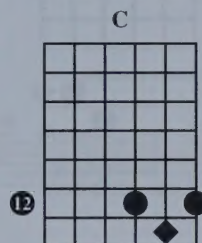
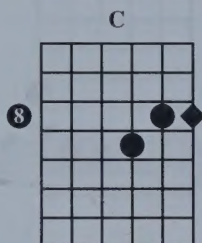
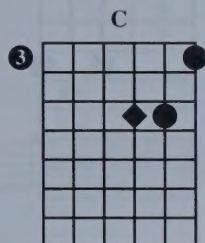
Let's look at how these shapes relate to one another.

1) The "D" shape at the fourth fret creates an E chord. Using the "B $\flat$ " shape we can create another E chord at the 7th fret. Finally, the "F" shape at the 12th fret also creates an E chord.

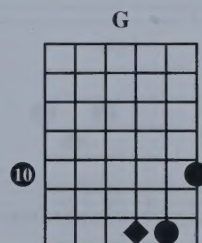
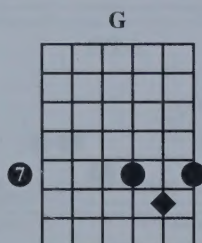
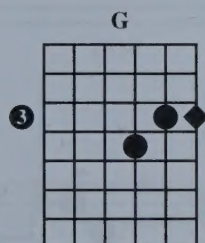


The other shapes work this way:

2) C chord = "B $\flat$ " shape at the 3rd fret, "F" at the 8th, "D" at the 12 fret.

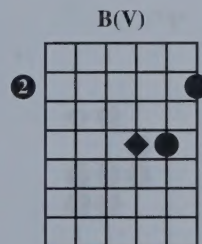
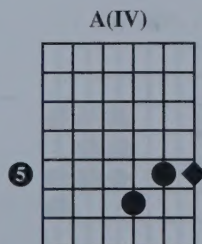
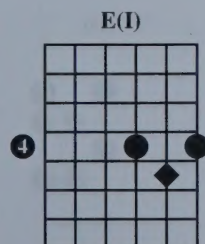


3) G chord = "F" shape at the 3rd fret, "D" chord at the 7th fret, "B $\flat$ " shape at the 10th fret.

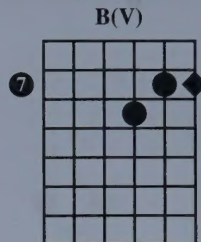
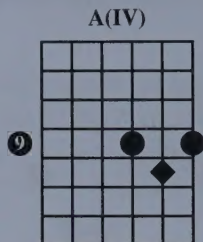
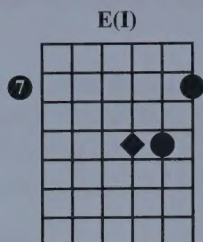


Progressions in Shapes

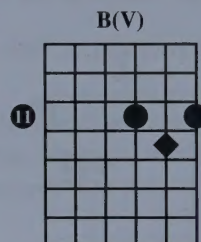
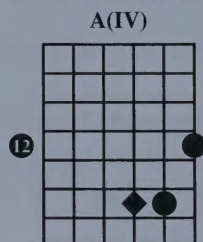
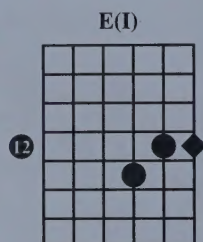
In the key of E, the "D" shape at the 4th fret is the I chord. The "F" shape at the 5th fret is the IV chord (A) and the "B $\flat$ " shape at the 2nd fret is the V chord (B). Practice changing between these three chord shapes until the pattern is familiar.



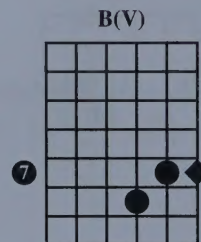
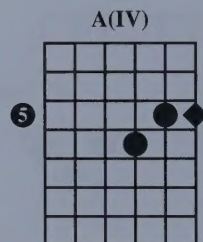
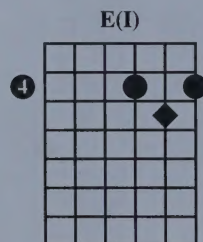
We can play the I, IV, V progression in E at other positions on the neck using the other shapes as the I chord. Play the “B $\flat$ ” shape of E at the 7th fret. The IV chord (A) is the “D” shape at the 9th fret. The V chord (B) is the “F” shape at the 7th fret. Practice this pattern until it is familiar.



Now play the E at the 12th fret in the “F” shape. The IV chord (A) is at the 12th fret in the “B $\flat$ ” shape. The V chord (B) is at the 11th fret in the “D” position.

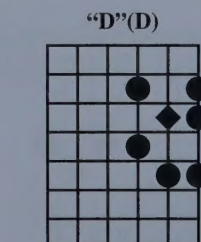
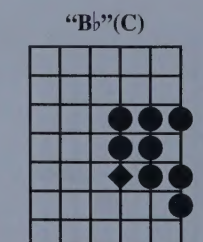
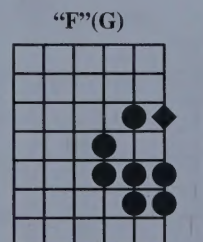


Notice also that you can play the I-IV-V progression using only two shapes by simply moving the IV chord “up” the neck two frets. (Note: “Up” the neck means higher in pitch and therefore closer to the body of the guitar.)



Lead Notes in the Shapes

Here are some lead notes that can be used in each shape. These notes are not complete scales or arpeggios, but are simply notes that are “in the shape” and can be used to solo over a chord.





G



3fr.

G



□□●● 7fr.

G7



10fr.

Left hand fingering 1 I 3

TAB 4 5 3 5 3 4 3 5 6 3 6 5 3 7 9 8 7-10-10-7 12 12 10-12-13

C



□□□□ 3fr.

C



□□□□●● 8fr

G



106

[illegible]

B

 2fr.

D

 5fr.

G



□ □ ● □ 7 ft

1 1

TAB 2 4 3 2 5 2 5 7 7 6 5 7 9 8 10 8 7 9 7 9 7 8

12 Bar Riff Blues

The 12 bar blues form is very common in western swing. “Milk Cow Blues,” “Brain Cloudy Blues,” “Corrina, Corrina,” and “Bob Wills Special” all use this progression which is:

I	I	I	I
IV	IV	I	I
V	V	I	I

“Riff Blues #1” shows how a single riff or lick can be used to build a solos on this progression. This riff falls in the “F” shape. The riff works well against the G and C chords but in measure 9, the G note clashes a bit with D chord which wants an F# note. The solo works because the ear “expects” the lick to resolve.

Riff Blues #1



G

Musical notation for the first system of Riff Blues #1, featuring a G chord. The notation includes a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 4/4 time signature. The melody consists of four measures: Measure 1 has a quarter rest, a quarter note F#, and a quarter note G; Measure 2 has a half note G and a half note F#; Measure 3 has a quarter note G, a quarter note F#, and a quarter note E; Measure 4 has a half note G and a half note F#. The bass line is indicated by fret numbers: 3-5, 3-3, 6-5-3, 5, 3, and 3-5.

C

G

Musical notation for the second system of Riff Blues #1, featuring C and G chords. The notation includes a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 4/4 time signature. The melody consists of four measures: Measure 1 has a quarter rest, a quarter note F#, and a quarter note G; Measure 2 has a half note G and a half note F#; Measure 3 has a quarter note G, a quarter note F#, and a quarter note E; Measure 4 has a half note G and a half note F#. The bass line is indicated by fret numbers: 3-3, 6-5-3, 5, 3, and 3-5.

D

G

Musical notation for the third system of Riff Blues #1, featuring D and G chords. The notation includes a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 4/4 time signature. The melody consists of four measures: Measure 1 has a quarter rest, a quarter note F#, and a quarter note G; Measure 2 has a half note G and a half note F#; Measure 3 has a quarter note G, a quarter note F#, and a quarter note E; Measure 4 has a half note G and a half note F#. The bass line is indicated by fret numbers: 3-3, 6-5-3-0, 3, and 3.

“Riff Blues #2” addresses the clashing problem against the V chord in measure 9 using a D note and ends with a different phrase.

Riff Blues #2



G

T
A
B

C G

T
A
B

D G

T
A
B

"Riff Blues #3" introduces the $\flat 7$ th tone to move the solo ahead. In this type progression the 7th chord is typically used in two different chord situations; a) going from the I to the IV and b) going from the V to the I. As a soloist, you can use the $\flat 7$ to setup the chord movement. The G and F $\sharp$ notes in measure 3 are chromatic tones leading to the F note in measure 4 which is the $\flat 7$ of the G7. Likewise, the chromatic tones in measure 9 lead to the C note in measure 10 which is the $\flat 7$ of the D7.

Riff Blues #3



Sheet music for "Riff Blues #3" in G major, 4/4 time. The music is divided into three systems, each with a guitar staff and a three-string bass staff (T, A, B).

System 1: Chords G and G7. The guitar staff shows a solo starting on G4, moving to G4 (b7), F#4, F4, E4, D4, C4, B3, A3, G3. The bass staff shows fret numbers: 3-5, 3-3, 6-5-3, 5-3, 5-4, 3.

System 2: Chords C and G. The guitar staff shows a solo starting on C4, moving to C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, F4, E4, D4, C4, B3, A3, G3. The bass staff shows fret numbers: 3-3-5-3-3-5, 3-6-5-3-5, 3-3-5-3-4, 3-5, 5.

System 3: Chords D, D7, and G. The guitar staff shows a solo starting on D4, moving to D4, E4, F4, G4, F4, E4, D4, C4, B3, A3, G3. The bass staff shows fret numbers: 3-3-3-6, 5-5-4-5-2, 5-4-3, 3-3.

“Riff Blues #4” is a more “notey” variation of the basic riff. In measure 8, the $\flat 7$ tone is used in a new situation, over the I chord. The scale pattern in measure 8-10 is ascending G scale pattern. The lick in measures 11-12 consists of G major chord tones (arpeggio) separated by chromatic notes.

Riff Blues #4



G **G7**

TAB

3	5	3	5	3	5	6	6	5	5	3	3	5	3	3	5	3	5
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

C **G**

TAB

3	3	5	3	5	3	5	3	6	5	3	5	3	5	3	4	3	5
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

D **D7** **G**

TAB

1	2	1	1	3	5	3	3	2	3	3	2	3	4	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

7th Position—D Shape

Here are “Riff Blues #1-4” played in the 7th position. As before, visualize the shape of the chord while learning this position.

Riff Blues #1 - 7th Position



G

Musical notation for Riff Blues #1 - 7th Position, G chord.

Staff 1 (Treble Clef): 4/4 time signature. Notes: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half).

Staff 2 (T, A, B): Fingering for the G chord in 7th position.

String	1	2	3	4	5
T					
A	7	9	8	8	
B			11	10	8

C

G

Musical notation for Riff Blues #1 - 7th Position, C and G chords.

Staff 1 (Treble Clef): 4/4 time signature. Notes: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), C4 (quarter), B3 (quarter), A3 (quarter), G3 (half).

Staff 2 (T, A, B): Fingering for the C and G chords in 7th position.

String	1	2	3	4	5
T	8	8			
A			11	10	8
B				9	7

D

G

Musical notation for Riff Blues #1 - 7th Position, D and G chords.

Staff 1 (Treble Clef): 4/4 time signature. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), C4 (quarter), B3 (quarter), A3 (half).

Staff 2 (T, A, B): Fingering for the D and G chords in 7th position.

String	1	2	3	4	5
T	8	8			
A			11	10	8
B				9	7

C

G

TAB

8	8	11	10	8	9	7	7	9
---	---	----	----	---	---	---	---	---

[illegible]

Riff Blues #3 - 7th Position



G G7

T					
A	7 9	8 8	11-10-8	9	7
B				10 9	8

C G

T	8 8 8 8 9	8 11-10-8	9	7 7	10 8 9
A					7 9
B					10

D D7 G

T	7 7 7	11	10 10 9	10 7	10
A					9 7
B					8 8

Riff Blues #4 - 7th Position



G **G7**

TAB: 7-9 | 8-10-8-9 | 11-11-10-10-8-7-9-8 | 7-10-8-9 | 7-9

C **G**

TAB: 8-8-9-8-10-8-9 | 8-11-10-8-9 | 7-10-8-9-7-9 | 10-10-9

D **D7** **G**

TAB: 7-9-10-7-9-10-7-9 | 10-7-9-10-7-9-7-10 | 8-8-7-8-7-6-7 | 9-8-9-10

The Major Scale and Arpeggio

In the riff blues we added notes to each shape. Here is the complete scale and arpeggio for each of our major shapes. Visualize the shapes as you memorize and practice each of these.

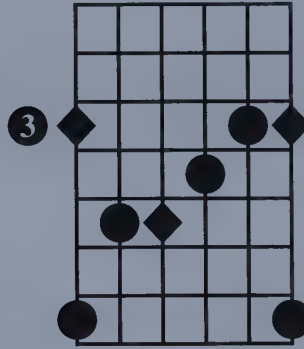


F

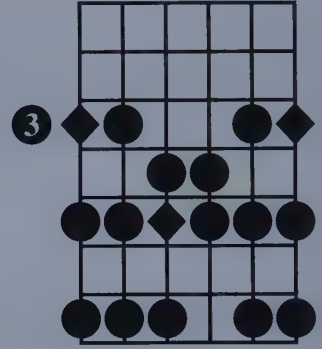
(actual key—G)



Arpeggio



Scale

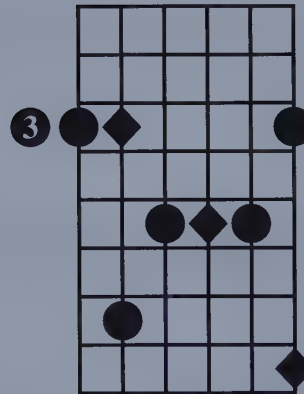


B $\flat$

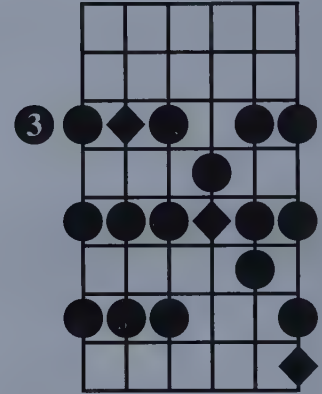
(actual key—C)



Arpeggio



Scale

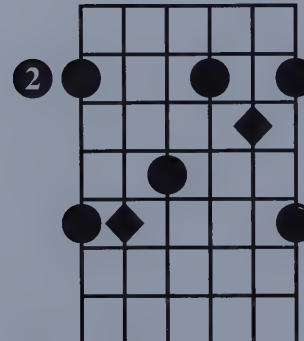


D

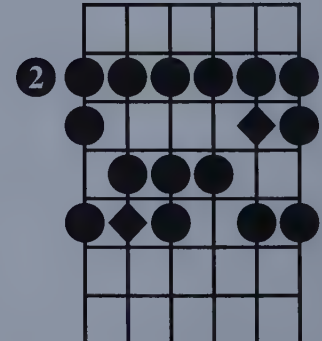
(actual key—D)



Arpeggio



Scale



Substitutions

In western swing, it is normal for the rhythm players to substitute chords over the basic chord changes of a song. Lead guitarists often play notes that imply substituted chords whether or not those chords are played in the rhythm section. We'll look at four types of substitution.

Direct Substitution/Embellishment - Any chord can be substituted for another chord of the same type. If the given chord is G major, we can substitute any G major type chord (Gmaj7, G6, etc) as long as we like the sound. The same goes for minor and dominant chords. An A minor chord could be played as a Am7 or Am9. A D7 chord could be played as a D11 or a D7b9. This approach is also called chord extension. It really comes down to this big if: If you like the sound - use the chord substitution.

Remember: As a soloist, we can play notes that fit the substituted chords *whether or not the rhythm players are using those substitutions!*

In "Arp Blues" the first four bars of G (I) have been replaced, using direct substitution, with G, Gmaj7, G6 and G7. The first three chords are all G major and the G7 is a dominant chord setting up the change to C (IV). The IV chord (C) is played here as a dominant, so we can use C7 and C9. We use the same substitution over the V chord (D) using D9 and D7.

The solo uses arpeggios (with connecting notes) of each of the substitution chords to create a more interesting sound. Remember, this solo could be played over the basic I-IV-V blues pattern.

Arp Blues



Arp Blues

Chords: G, Gmaj7, G6, G7, C9, C7, G, (Am) D9, D7, G

Arpeggios (T, A, B strings):

1 3 4 3 2 5 3 2 3 5 3 4 5 4 3 5 4 3 5 4 3

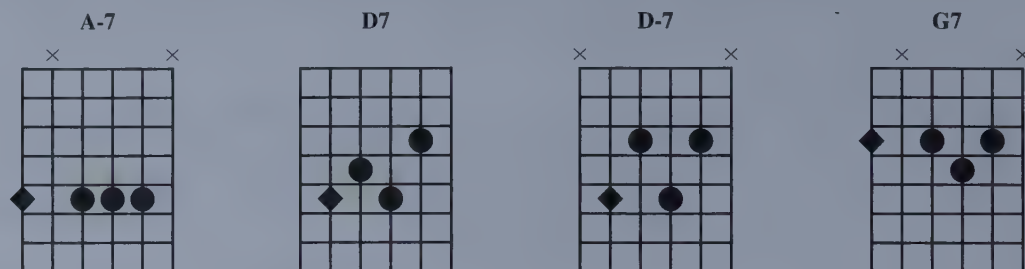
(M7) (b7) (b7)

3 3

2 3 2 5 2 3 3 3 2 5 2 5 3 2 5 4 3 5 4 3 4

3 1 3 5 8 7 5 7 9 7 10 8 7 10 8 7 8 7 10 9 7 7 8 7 10

Minor Substitution - For any dominant chord, substitute a minor chord built on the fifth of the original chord. For example, if the given chord is D7, we can substitute an A minor. This is a very common substitution in western swing. It is easier to understand on the fingerboard:



“Minor Sub Riff Blues” uses minor substitution in two situations. We are already using G7 to move from I to IV. Now we can split the G7 measure into two beats each of Dm and G7. (It often sounds best to resolve the substitution back to the original chord before moving on.)

Secondly, we substitute Am for the D7 in the V to I measures. Notice that using direct substitution, we have extended the minor chords to become 9ths and 7ths.

Minor Sub Riff Blues



Chord progression: G, Dm9, G9

Measure 1: G (3 5) | Measure 2: G (3 5 3 5) | Measure 3: G (6 6 5 5 3 3 5 3) | Measure 4: G (3 5 3 4) | Measure 5: Dm9 (4) | Measure 6: G9 (2 5 4 3 6 5)

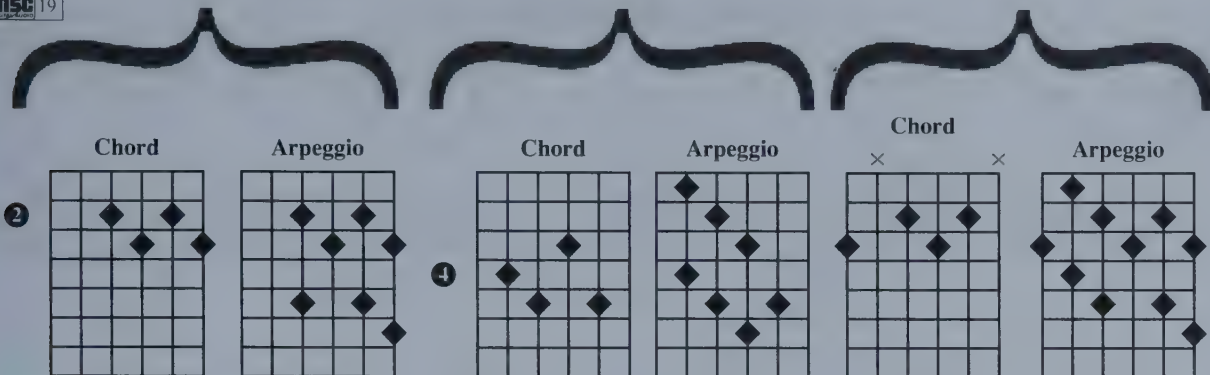
Chord progression: C, G, (b7)

Measure 1: C (3 3 5 3 5 3 5) | Measure 2: C (3 6 5 3 5) | Measure 3: C (3 5 3 4 3 5) | Measure 4: C (6 5 4)

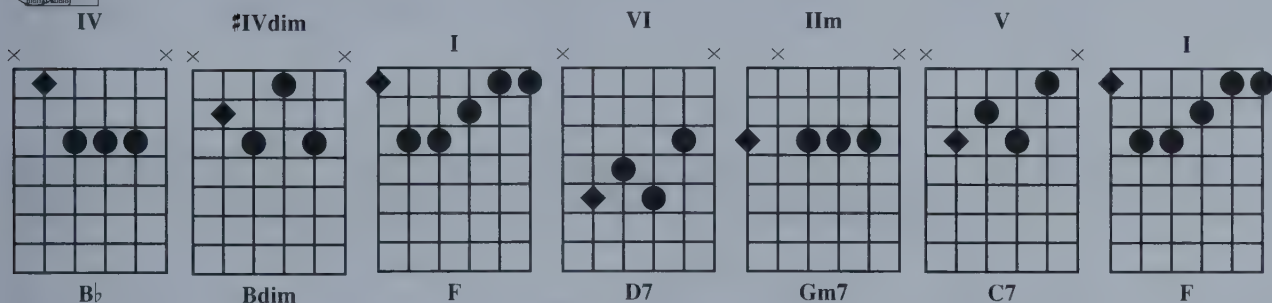
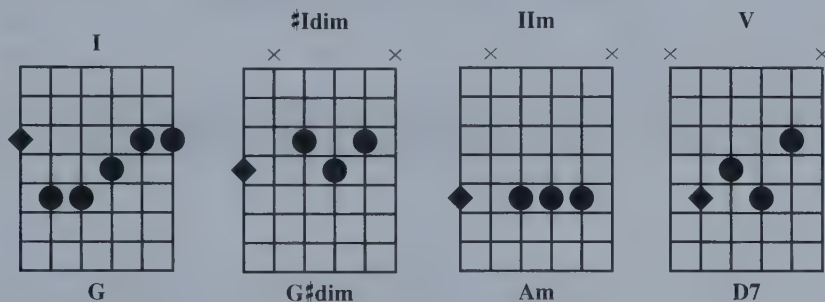
Chord progression: Am7, D7, G

Measure 1: Am7 (7 5 5 8 7 5 7 6) | Measure 2: Am7 (5 7 5 5 7 5 7 5) | Measure 3: D7 (3 3 2 3 3 2 3) | Measure 4: D7 (4 3 4 5)

Diminished Substitution - When diminished chords occur in swing tunes as part of the arrangement, they are not substitutions. They can be used as substitutions for dominant chords. Three string diminished shapes are a convenient way to organize diminished arpeggios.

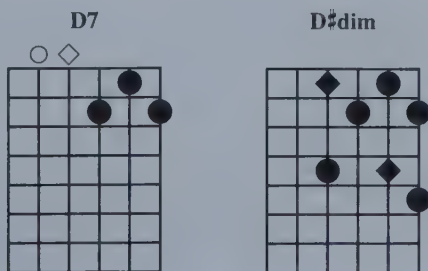


A. When diminished chords appear as part of the chord progression, they generally act as “connectors.” Two very common uses are the I, $\sharp$ Idim, IIm, V progression (“Straighten Up and Fly Right”) and the IV $\sharp$ IVdim, I/VI, II/V, I progression (“Beaumont Rag.”)



B. When diminished chords are used as substitutions, they are often used to substitute for a dominant chord. This works because an 7 $\flat$ 9 arpeggio and a diminished arpeggio 1/2 step higher are nearly identical. A G7 $\sharp$ 9 spells G B D F G $\sharp$ and G $\sharp$ dim spells G $\sharp$ B D F.

When substituting a diminished scale or arpeggio for a dominant chord, choose the diminished 1/2 step higher than the original dominant chord.



Here is a blues which incorporates the diminished substitution idea.

Note: Diminished and augmented substitutions are stronger sounding which should be used judiciously.

Dim Riff Blues



Sheet music for "Dim Riff Blues" in 4/4 time, featuring guitar and bass staves with tablature and chord indications.

First System:

- Chords: G, G7, (G7 $\flat$ 9), G $\sharp$ dim
- Tablature: 3 5 | 3 5 3 5 | 6 6 5 5 3 3 5 3 | 3 5 5 3 4 | 3 4 3 6 4

Second System:

- Chords: C, (C7 $\flat$ 9), C $\sharp$ dim, G, (G7 $\flat$ 9), G $\sharp$ dim
- Tablature: 3 3 5 3 5 3 5 | 3 5 2 3 5 2 5 | 3 5 3 4 3 5 | 6 6 3 4 6

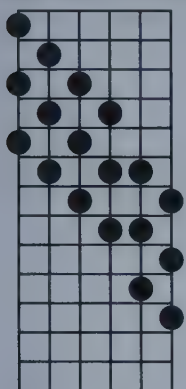
Third System:

- Chords: D, (D7 $\flat$ 9), D $\sharp$ dim, G
- Tablature: 2 4 5 2 4 5 3 4 | 5 3 4 2 5 2 5 | 3 3 2 3 3 2 3 | 4 3 4 5

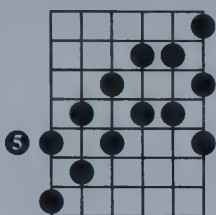
Augmented Substitution - As with diminished chords, augmented chords are sometimes part of the basic progression of a song. More often, however, they are substituted for dominant chords, especially in the I-IV and V-I chord situations. An augmented chord spells 1 3 $\sharp 5$. The whole-tone scale (no 1/2 steps) is used to play over these chords. Here are some whole tone scale patterns.



Three notes per string



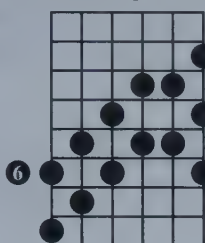
Two notes per string



Works with these augmented chords:

A, B, C $\sharp$,
D $\sharp$, F, G

Two notes per string



Works with these augmented chords:

B $\flat$, C, D,
E, F $\sharp$, G $\sharp$

Note: There are only two whole-tone scales—the even frets and the odd frets. If your substitution sounds wrong, move the phrase up or down, one fret. It often sounds best to mix diminished and augmented substitutions as in the next blues.

Aug Dim Riff Blues



Chord progression: G $\flat$, G7, G $\sharp$, C, C $\sharp$ dim, G, G $\sharp$ dim, D, D $\sharp$, G

1 3 1 3 1 3

4 1

1 1 2 1 3 1 3 1 3 1

TAB

3 5 3 5 3 5 6 6 5 5 3 3 3 5 5 3 4 3 4 6 4 6 3 5

3 3 3 5 3 5 3 2 3 5 2 5 3 5 3 4 3 5 6 6 3 4 6

2 4 5 2 4 5 3 4 3 5 3 5 2 5 3 3 3 2 3 3 2 3 4 3 4 5

Thoughts About Learning to Use Substitutions

Add these substitution ideas into your playing slowly. So many options can be confusing and sometimes result in crazy sounding, non-focused solos. Tiny Moore (Bob Wills' great electric mandolinist in the 1940s) advised that each new substitution idea should be worked on individually over a course of months. For example, take the idea of using an augmented lick over a dominant chord to move from a I to a IV chord. Tiny suggested using that one idea over and over for weeks until 1) you understand how and when to use it, 2) you know how it will sound before you play it and 3) all your friends are sick of hearing it! Repeat this process with each idea until you develop an arsenal of musical concepts to dress up your solos.

All Together Now

Here is blues solo which incorporates many of the scale positions and substitution ideas. As you work through these solos, listen for licks and phrases to add to your own soloing and watch familiar shapes!

Clark's Blues



Clark's Blues

Chords: B $\flat$, E $\flat$, E $\dim$, B $\flat$

Chords: B $\flat$ 7, B $\flat$ +, E $\flat$, E $\dim$

Chords: B $\flat$, B $\dim$, Cm7

1

4 1

TAB

6 7 6 8 8 6 8 9 6 8 9 6 6 8 6 7 8 7

6 7 7 8 6 5 6 5 8 6 5 8 5 7 5 8 6 5 8 7

6 8 5 6 7 8 5 8 9 7 6 8 11 8 8 10 9 8

G^bdim B^b

1 1 1

TAB 7 10 8 7 6 8 5 6 7 6 8 7 8 5 8 10 11 10

E^b7 B^b Fm7 B^b9

1 4 2

TAB 11 10 11 13 10 11 13 12 11 14 13 11 12 6 6 8 6 6 8 6 5 8 7 6 9 8

E^bMaj7 Edim B^b Bdim

1 1 4

TAB 6 8 7 8 5 6 8 7 8 6 5 8 5 6 8 6 7 8 5 9 6 7 9

Cm G^bdim F7 B^b

1

TAB 5 7 8 6 8 5 8 7 5 8 7 6 8 5 6 7 8 6 8 8

More Solos

The next solos were inspired by noted western swing guitarists. The progressions are some of the popular in western swing. Play through these arrangements and then the ideas to create your own original solos.

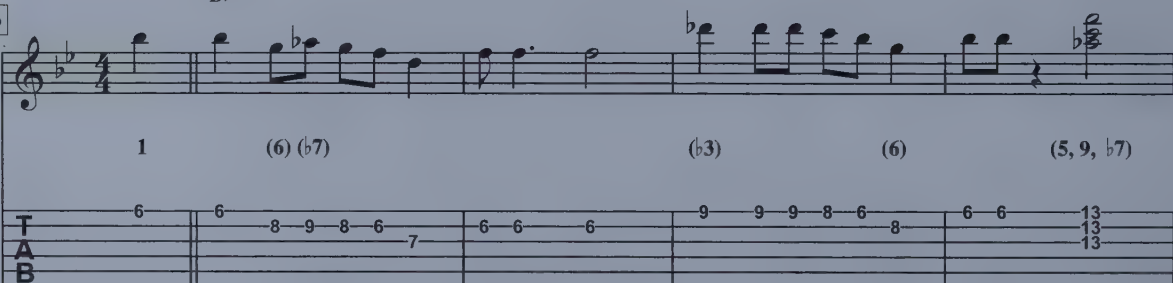
Note: In this book, pickup measures are not numbered. Numbered measures begin after the double measure lines.

The first Western Swing lead guitarists played standard acoustic guitars. They played in styles influenced by players such as Eddie Lang and French guitarist Django Reinhardt, among others. **Sleepy Johnson** was a multi-instrumentalist who was a member Bob Will's Texas Playboys in the 1930s. Johnson's style was similar to that of Karl Farr of the Sons of the Pioneers who also recorded in the 1930s.

The solo begins largely in the "F" shape with the first finger at the 6th fret. The first measure uses the 6 (G) and b7 (Ab) of the Bb chord. Measure 3 begins with the b3 (Db). The b3 and b7 tones convey the bluesy sound while the 6 and 9 are popular tones in swing. Measure 4 features a Bb9 (dominant) chord made up of b7 (Ab), 9 (C) and 5 (F) setting up the IV chord. Measures 5-6 use the "Bb" shape while measures 7-8 hint at the "D" shape. Measures 9-10 use the "F" shape again and the final measures return to the "D" shape as in 7-8. Notice that unlike some later solos, the shapes change here with every new chord.

Sleepy Blues

 **Bb** **Bb9**



1 (6) (b7) (b3) (6) (5, 9, b7)

T 6 6 8-9-8-6 7 6-6-6 9-9-9-8-6 8 6-6 13-13-13

A

B

Eb **Bb**



3 (b7) 3

T 8 7-8-6 8-9-9-9-8-6-8 13-13-13-13 14-13 11-11-11-11

A

B

F7 **Bb** **Eb** **Bb**



3 4 2 3 1 2 3

T 15 13-14 15-15-15-13 14-13 11 13-13-11-13 14-13 11

A

B

Oklahoma native **Eldon Shamblin** brought extensive musical knowledge to the **Bob Wills Band**. Many of Wills' 1940s big band recordings were arranged by Shamblin. The effect of his many years of association with Wills on the sound and arrangements of modern western swing can not be over stressed. Although Eldon did not solo as much as some other Playboy guitarists, his style reflects a sophisticated knowledge of music and a swinging drive.

This common progression works for songs such as "That's What I Like About the South," "Nagasaki" and "Miss Molly."

(I #V)	V	(I #V)	V
I	(IV #IVdim)	V	I

Chord Reduction: Here is a good example of how, especially in fast tunes, chords can sometimes be consolidated or ignored by the soloist. Since the F7 (bV) chord only lasts two beats and resolves chromatically to the E7 (V) chord, this solo treats measures 1-2 as a V chord and measures 3-4 as a I chord. Similarly, the D#dim is ignored both times it appears. This technique is used throughout the solo. Although the notes in a given measure may relate to the current chord (as shown) they may relate more logically to the I or V chord.

Anticipation: This common swing and jazz technique is evident in measures 4, 5 & 14 where the last notes in the measure move to the next chord "early" or before the chord change. Anticipation gives a solo sense of forward movement.



photo courtesy of author's collection

Bob Will's Texas Playboys were a driving force in the development of Western Swing

This solo begins with a descending whole-tone lick, creating an augmented feel which resolves to the A chord in measure 3. The solo stays in A until the IV chord in measure 6. The solo continues with A ideas until the D6 arpeggio in measure 14. Notice the effective use of F# (6) in measures 12-13. The dominant 11th arpeggio in measures 15-16 is an exciting modern treatment of the V chord.



Eldon's Rag

A F7 E7 A F7 E7

(6)

TAB

A D D#dim F7

(6) (9) (6) (11) (9)

TAB

A F7 E7 A F7 E7

H P

TAB

A D D#dim E7 A

(6) (9) (11) (b7)

TAB

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Jimmy Wyble and **Cameron Hill** played together in Wills' band in the early 1940s. Their duet guitar work was a unique addition to the Texas Playboys sound. Wyble seemed to do most of the solo guitar work on recordings in this period. His modern syncopated style was clearly influenced by jazz pioneer Charlie Christian.

The first two solos demonstrate how a 12 bar blues can be played largely in one position (with a few stretches.) These solos remain around the fifth position until measures 20-21, where it shifts to the 7th position.

The 1st solo begins in the "F" shape and shifts below the shape (4th fret) for the G# note in measure 3. In measure 8, the first finger slides out of position again for one note to get the striking D# (b5). The V chord is played in the "D" shape in measures 9-10 returning to "F" in measure 11 to begin solo #2. The "Bb" shape is used for the V chord in measures 20-21 and the solo ends back in the "F" shape.

Jimmy's Blues



A

(9) (9) 4 1

TAB

D

3 (b7)

TAB

A **E**

3 (b5) 1 1 (9) (b7)

TAB

A

4 1 3 1

TAB

A

Musical notation for the A chord. The staff shows a sequence of notes: A4, B4, C#5, D5, E5, F#5, G#5, A5, B5, C#6, D6, E6, F#6, G#6, A6. The fretboard diagram shows the following fret numbers: 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 9, 4, 7, 5, 8, 7, 5.

D

Musical notation for the D chord. The staff shows a sequence of notes: D4, E4, F#4, G#4, A4, B4, C#5, D5, E5, F#5, G#5, A5, B5, C#6, D6, E6, F#6, G#6, A6. The fretboard diagram shows the following fret numbers: 7, 5, 7, 5, 7, 5, 5, 7, 5, 7, 5, 8, 8, 8, 8.

A

E

Musical notation for the A and E chords. The staff shows a sequence of notes: A4, B4, C#5, D5, E5, F#5, G#5, A5, B5, C#6, D6, E6, F#6, G#6, A6. The fretboard diagram shows the following fret numbers: 8, 5, 7, 5, 5, 5, 5, 9, 9, 7, 9, 7, 9, 7, 9, 8, 7, 7, 4.

A

Musical notation for the A chord. The staff shows a sequence of notes: A4, B4, C#5, D5, E5, F#5, G#5, A5, B5, C#6, D6, E6, F#6, G#6, A6. The fretboard diagram shows the following fret numbers: 7, 5, 7, 5, 6, 5, 7, 5, 5, 8, 7, 5, 7, 6, 5, 7, 6.



“Jimmy’s Blues #2” begins with a classic swing phrase in the “D” shape. Measures 5-6 use the F shape. The Bm9 (E13) arpeggio in measure 8 anticipates the V chord in 9.

Jimmy’s Blues #2



A

D

A **E**

A

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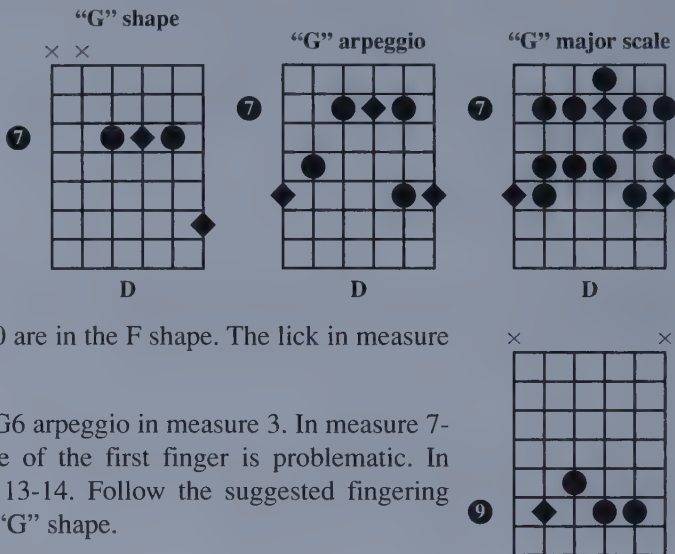
The next two solos are in the same style and fit the following progression: **I I IV II V V I I**



This popular progression appears many times in western swing tunes including "Texas Playboy Rag" and "San Antonio Rose." The second solo introduces a new shape and the arpeggio and major scale associated with it.

Solo 1 begins in the D shape at the second fret. The D shape is also used in the 4th measure for the II chord (E). Use the F shape for measures 5-6 and shift to the D shape in measures 7-8. Measures 9-10 are in the F shape. The lick in measure 11 outlines a G9 chord.

Solo 2 begins in the G shape. There is a useful G6 arpeggio in measure 3. In measure 7-8, experiment with fingerings if the indicated use of the first finger is problematic. In measure 10 shift to the 12th fret until measures 13-14. Follow the suggested fingering closely here. Measures 15-16 return to the 7th fret "G" shape.



Jimmy's Rag



Sheet music for "Jimmy's Rag" in 4/4 time, key of D major. The music is divided into three systems, each with a treble clef staff and a guitar tablature staff.

System 1: Chords D, G, E. Measures 1-4. Fingering: (6), (b3), (9), 1, 1, 1. Tablature: 2-4-3-2-6-7, 5-5-6-6, 6-6-5-7-7-5, 7-7-5-7-6-5-4-5.

System 2: Chords A, D, A. Measures 5-8. Fingering: 1, 1, (b7), (9), 1, (b5), 2. Tablature: 4-4-5-6-7-6, 5-7-5, 9-10-12-9-10-11, 12-9-10-12-10-12-10.

System 3: Chords D, G, E. Measures 9-12. Fingering: 1, (6), (b7), 1, (b7) (9) (b9) (b3), 3. Tablature: 10-11-12-10-11-12, 10-11-12-10-11, 10-9-11-11, 9-9-10-11-12.

A D

4 (b7) (9) 1 (b7) 1 1

TAB

Solo 2 D G E

1 (6) (9)

TAB

A D

1 1 1 1 1 1

TAB

G E

1 2 1 (6)

TAB

A D

1 3 1 1 1 4 1 4 2 1 2 1 1 2 3 1

TAB

Junior Bernard was one of the most distinctive Texas Playboy guitarists. His aggressive style and distorted tone in the late 1940s foreshadowed rock n' roll by ten years.

The next solo features a very simple fiddle tune type chord progression. These tunes are hard to solo over because there is so little chord movement. This solo contains several licks that are useful in static chord situations.

The solo begins with a three measure G lick in the F shape.

Measure 4-7, also use the F shape at the 10th fret. Three note arpeggios fill measure 9, while measures 10-11 stay in the D shape at the 7th fret. In measure 12, the V (D) chord is played in the F shape. The chromatic lick in measures 13-14 is a great way to move from V to I. The solo ends with a three note G6 arpeggio (D shape).

Junior's Tune

disc 32

G D

H

TAB

(b7) (9)

G

D

(6) (9) (11) (6)

H H

G

(9) (6)

TAB

The musical score for "Junior's Tune" is presented in four systems. Each system consists of a guitar staff and a corresponding TAB staff. The key signature is one sharp (F#). The first system starts with a G chord and includes a three-measure G lick in the F shape, followed by measures 4-7 in the F shape at the 10th fret, measure 9 with three-note arpeggios, and measures 10-11 in the D shape at the 7th fret. The second system continues with measures 12-14, including a chromatic lick and a three-note G6 arpeggio. The third system shows measures 15-16 and 17-18, with a D chord indicated. The fourth system concludes the piece with measures 19-20, including a G chord and a final three-note G6 arpeggio. The TAB staff provides fret numbers and fingerings for each note, with some measures containing multiple fret numbers for different voicings or techniques. A "disc 32" logo is located in the top left corner of the first system.

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In the 1950s, Texas Playboys such as left hander **Cotton Whittington** further embellished the sound created by earlier guitarists. Here are two solos to a very popular progression which is used for "Twinkle Little Star," "Brown Skin Gal," "Red Skin Gal" and others. This progression is:

I	I	(IV #IVdim)	I
I	I	II	V
I	I	(IV #IVdim)	V
(IV #IVdim)	(I VI)	(II V)	I

Cotton Picking



G C C#dim G

1 1 (b3) (6)

T 2-3 3 3 5 3 5-3-4 3-4 5 3 5-3 6 7-3 5-3-3

A 5 3 5 5-3-4 3-4 5 3 5-3 6 7-3 5-3-3

B

A D

(6) (M7) 1 (9) 3 3 1 (b7) (9) (b7) 2

T 3-4 5 4 3-5 2 5-3 7 5 5 6 5 8 7 5 8 8-7 8 10-8

A 3-4 5 4 3-5 2 5-3 7 5 5 6 5 8 7 5 8 8-7 8 10-8

B

G C C#dim G

(6) 1 1 3 3 1 4 1

T 7 8 9 8 7 10 8 7-10 8 8 9 11 12 10 12 12 8

A 7 8 9 8 7 10 8 7-10 8 8 9 11 12 10 12 12 8

B

C C#dim G E A D G

3 1 3 1 4 1 1 15

T 9 8-10-8 11-8 10-8 12 10 14-14-12 15 11-12-8 14 12 12-15 15

A 9 8-10-8 11-8 10-8 12 10 14-14-12 15 11-12-8 14 12 12-15 15

B

Solo 2

G

C

C#dim

G

Treble clef, key of D major (F#), 4/4 time. Chords: G, G(b7), C, C#dim, G. Fingering numbers are provided for the guitar.

T	3	5	6	5	6	6	5	3	5	3	4	3	5	3	5	4	3	5	2
A																			
B																			

A

D

Treble clef, key of D major (F#), 4/4 time. Chords: (M7), (6), A(b7), (9), D(b7). Fingering numbers are provided for the guitar.

T	4	2	5	4	2	5	4	5	4	3	6	5	8	7	5	7	8	8	7	5	7
A																					
B																					

G

C

C#dim

G

Treble clef, key of D major (F#), 4/4 time. Chords: G, C, C#dim, G. Fingering numbers are provided for the guitar.

T	8	12	8	12	8	12	8	8	9	8	9	8	10	11	7	8	7	8	3	5
A																				
B																				

C

C#dim

G

E

A

D

G

Treble clef, key of D major (F#), 4/4 time. Chords: C(b7), G(b7), A, D, G. Fingering numbers are provided for the guitar.

T	6	6	5	3	3	5	6	6	5	3	3	3	2	5	5	4	4	5	3
A																			
B																			

In later years, western swing guitarists started using more modern jazz guitar sounds. Nashville country jazz greats such as **Leon Rhodes**, **Harold Bradley** and **Hank Garland** pushed the boundaries of country and swing.

This solo begins in the “F” shape at the eight fret. The lick in measure 3 is very modern sounding, containing the $\flat 5$, $\flat 7$, 9, and 13 of the F chord. The D9 lick in measure 4 is also in the “F” shape. The augmented sub rule is put to good use in measures 5-6.

Harold's Rag



1

C F

($\flat 7$) (9) ($\flat 5$) (13)

1 2 2

TAB

8-9-10 8-10-8 10-11-10-8 10-11-10-8 11-10-8-9 10-8-10 7-10-8-7

D G C

2 ($\flat 7$) (9) 1 1 1 2 3 1 2

TAB

11-10-13 12-10 8-10 6-8 6-8 4 5 6 6-8 6-8 9 8-10-8-11-8-10

F D

2

TAB

8 9 8-10-8 11-8-10 14 13-15 16-15-13-15-13 14 13-16-13-15 16-13-15 13-15

G C

1 1 1 1 1 1

TAB

4 6 4-6 6-8 6-8 8-10 8-10 7-8-10-7 8 10-8-10-8 10-8-9 8 8

This next solo presents the great **Charlie Christian** style. The solo stays mostly in the “F” shape at the sixth fret. Notice the use of jazz effects such as delayed entry, un-expected rests and anticipation.



Charlie's Blues

B $\flat$

8 7 6 6 9 8 6 8 6 7 8 8

E $\flat$

8 8 7 8 7 8 7 8 6 8 7

B $\flat$

F

8 6 7 6 6 9 8 6 6 7 6 8 9 10 10 9 8 8 10 9 8 10 8

B $\flat$

8 10 8 6 7 8 7 6 8 6 7 8 8 8 7 8

First system of musical notation. The top staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The bottom staff is a guitar TAB with three lines labeled T, A, and B. The TAB contains the following fret numbers: 9 9, 9 9, 9 8 6, 8 7, 6 8 6 7, 6 6.

Second system of musical notation. The top staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The bottom staff is a guitar TAB with three lines labeled T, A, and B. The TAB contains the following fret numbers: 8 9 8 6, 8 6 9, 6 8 7 5, 6 8 7 6 5 8 5. A chord symbol E^b is written above the staff.

Third system of musical notation. The top staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The bottom staff is a guitar TAB with three lines labeled T, A, and B. The TAB contains the following fret numbers: 6 8 6 7, 8 5 8 8, 9 6 7 9, 10 7 8 10 8, 10 8. Chord symbols B^b and F are written above the staff.

Fourth system of musical notation. The top staff is a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The bottom staff is a guitar TAB with three lines labeled T, A, and B. The TAB contains the following fret numbers: 7 10 8 7 6 8 5 6, 7 8 6 8. A chord symbol B^b is written above the staff.

Twin Guitars

Harmonized solos between two or more instruments was a popular device in early Western Swing. In the early 1940s, the Texas Playboys featured two electric guitarists; **Jimmy Wyble** and **Cameron Hill**. Many of their recordings from this period include the two guitars playing solos in harmony, much like a horn section.

Duets and trios combining guitars, mandolin and steel are still a common device in the music. These solos take considerable time to “work-up,” which may explain why often the same solo appears on recordings of several different songs.

The slow tempo of the first duet allows for more rhythmic variation. This blues solo contains several “odd” features. Note the change to 2/4 in measure 6. Also note the unusual chord sequence.

Guitar Blues for Two-Lead



Gtr. I

A

First system of musical notation for Guitar I (Gtr. I) and Bass (B). The system includes a treble clef staff with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#) and a 4/4 time signature. The melody starts with a quarter note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The bass line starts with a quarter note G2, followed by a quarter note A2, a quarter note B2, and a quarter note C3. The system includes a measure rest and a measure with a triplet of eighth notes (G4, A4, B4) and a quarter note C5. The system ends with a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The system includes a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5.

D

Second system of musical notation for Guitar I (Gtr. I) and Bass (B). The system includes a treble clef staff with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#) and a 4/4 time signature. The melody starts with a quarter note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The bass line starts with a quarter note G2, followed by a quarter note A2, a quarter note B2, and a quarter note C3. The system includes a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The system ends with a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The system includes a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5.

D#dim

A

E7

Third system of musical notation for Guitar I (Gtr. I) and Bass (B). The system includes a treble clef staff with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#) and a 4/4 time signature. The melody starts with a quarter note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The bass line starts with a quarter note G2, followed by a quarter note A2, a quarter note B2, and a quarter note C3. The system includes a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The system ends with a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The system includes a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5.

A

Fourth system of musical notation for Guitar I (Gtr. I) and Bass (B). The system includes a treble clef staff with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#) and a 4/4 time signature. The melody starts with a quarter note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The bass line starts with a quarter note G2, followed by a quarter note A2, a quarter note B2, and a quarter note C3. The system includes a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The system ends with a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5. The system includes a measure rest and a measure with a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B4, and a quarter note C5.

Guitar Blues for Two-Harmony

Gtr. II

A

7 4 | 6 6 6 6 5 4 | 7 7 4 | 7 7 7 7 6 5 4 | 4 5 4 7 6 7

D

1 1 2 2

6 4 5 | 3 4 7 5 5 | 5 7 5 7 4 |

D#dim

A

E7

1

7 4 | 7 | 4 5 | 4 3 4 6

A

3 2

4 3 2 5 4 3 4 2 | 6 6 6 | 6 6 5 5

The next blues solo takes a more “notey” approach.

Two Guitar Boogie



A

T
A
B

D

T
A
B

A **E**

T
A
B

A **E**

T
A
B

Two Guitar Boogie-Harmony

A

1 1 1 1

TAB 7 6 6 5 6 5 10 9 12 9 11 9 10 8 9 9

D

1 1 1

TAB 8 9 10 8 9 10 11 9 12 10 8 12 10 12 9 12 8 12 10 11 10 8 11

A E

1 1 4 1

TAB 12 17 14 12 14 14 12 14 8 11 8 10 7 8 6 7 7 8 8 8 9

A E

1 1 1

TAB 9 9 10 10 11 9 9 11 9 10 8 9 12 9

This duet fits the chorus section of songs like “San Antonio Rose” or “Texas Playboy Rag.”

Harmony Rag



Gr. I

A D B

E A

D B

E A

TAB

TAB

TAB

TAB

Gtr. II

First system of music for Gtr. II. The staff is in 4/4 time with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is marked with chords A, D, and B. The tablature below the staff shows the fret numbers for each note.

Chords: A, D, B

Tablature: 9 10 | 9 9 10 8 7 8 9 | 10 11 10 10 10 10 11

Second system of music for Gtr. II. The staff is in 4/4 time with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is marked with chords E and A. The tablature below the staff shows the fret numbers for each note.

Chords: E, A

Tablature: 12 10 9 12 | 9 11 9 12 | 10 10 10 11 10 11 10 13

Third system of music for Gtr. II. The staff is in 4/4 time with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is marked with chords D and B. The tablature below the staff shows the fret numbers for each note.

Chords: D, B

Tablature: 12 9 10 | 9 | 10 10 10 10 10 10 10 | 12 11 11

Fourth system of music for Gtr. II. The staff is in 4/4 time with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is marked with chords E and A. The tablature below the staff shows the fret numbers for each note.

Chords: E, A

Tablature: 9 10 | 11 12 | 9 12 9 | 11 10 9

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Western Swing Lead Guitar Styles

by Joe Carr

Take it Away! Unlock the secrets of hot "take-off" lead guitar as played by the greatest players from the greatest bands. Western Swing master Joe Carr has transcribed the great guitar solos from the Bob Wills band and other greats and breaks them down note by note into useful licks that can be used to improvise original hot solos. Includes solos by western swing legends Eldon Shamblin, Jimmy Wyble, Leon Rhodes, Junior Benard (often called the first rockabilly) and more. The accompanying audio uses classic western swing song progressions and presents the licks at a medium, learnable pace. Written in standard notation and tablature. Audio download available online.

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